# Minutes of the
# General Government Committee Meeting
# Held in the River Plate Room, Ajax Town Hall
# At 1:00 p.m. on September 9, 2019

***Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:***
*accessibility@ajax.ca or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347*

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| Present: | Chair - Councillor | A. Khan |
| | Regional Councillors | M. Crawford |
| | | S. Lee |
| | | J. Dies |
| | Councillors | R. Tyler Morin |
| | | L. Bower |
| | Mayor | S. Collier |

## 1. Call to Order

Chair Khan called the meeting to order at 1:00 p.m.

## 2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interests.

## 3. Adoption of Minutes

### 3.1 Regular Meeting

Moved by: S. Lee

That the Minutes of the regular meeting of the General Government Committee held on June 10, 2019 be adopted.

CARRIED

With the consent of members present, item 6.1 was advanced in the order of business.

## 6. Presentations

### 6.1 2018 Financial Statements and Audit Report

Steve Stewart, Partner, Deloitte LLP, reviewed the contents of the 2018 Financial Statements and Audit Report. Mr. Stewart discussed highlights of the audited financial statements, municipal accounting practices and standards, internal control practices, statement of financial position, and reported surplus.

Committee Members asked questions regarding collection and expenditure of development charges, temporary investments held by the Town, and the operating surplus amount. Mr. Stewart and Sandra Serrao, Acting Director of Finance / Treasurer, responded to questions from Committee Members.

Moved by: L. Bower

That the 2018 Financial Statements and Audit Report presentation be received for information.

CARRIED

## 4. Consent Agenda

Members separated items 4.1, 4.2, 4.3, 4.6, and 4.8 for discussion.

Moved by: M. Crawford

That items 4.4, 4.5, 4.7, and 4.9 of the consent agenda be adopted.

CARRIED

### 4.1 Insurance Renewal – July 1, 2019 to June 30, 2020

Committee Members asked questions regarding the Town's claims experience in recent years, site inspections at Ajax Fire Station #2 and the St. Francis Centre, and use of refunds from the insurance pool. S. Serrao reviewed the Town's recent claims history. Catherine Bridgeman, Director of Operations and Environmental Services, reviewed the results of site inspections at Fire Station #2 and the St. Francis Centre, and discussed the use of refunds from the insurance pool for further risk mitigation.

Moved by: L. Bower

That the report on the Insurance Renewal – July 1, 2019 to June 30, 2020 be received for information.

CARRIED

### 4.2 Contract Award – Greenwood Discovery Pavilion Driveway Reconstruction

Committee Members asked questions regarding reasons for the over-budget amount, budgeting and procurement practices for estimating capital project costs, consultation with the Toronto and Region Conservation Authority (TRCA), and review of the management agreement with TRCA. Ranil Fernando, Infrastructure and Asset Management Engineer, responded to questions from Committee Members, reviewed the costs associated with the over-budget amount, and explained consultation with the TRCA throughout the capital project. C. Bridgeman discussed the Town's capital budgeting and cost estimate practices, and reviewed discussions with the TRCA regarding the Greenwood property.

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That the report on the contract award to Royalcrest Paving & Contracting Ltd., in the amount of $621,484.12 (inclusive of all taxes) for the Greenwood Discovery Pavilion Driveway Re-Construction be received for information.

2. That the report on the contract award to CIMA in the amount of $67,794.02 (inclusive of all taxes) for the Greenwood Discovery Pavilion Driveway Contract Administration and Inspection Services be received for information.

3. That Council approve the transfer to the General Infrastructure Maintenance Reserve, the amount of $233,000.00 from the deferral of a portion of Capital Account 1005111 Village Greenbelt Trail.

4. That Council approve the transfer to the General Infrastructure Maintenance Reserve, the amount of $25,000.00 from the closing of Capital Account 997411 Soccer Post Replacement.

5. That Council approve funding of $356,919.60 to be allocated to Capital Account No. 997611 from General Infrastructure Maintenance Reserve.

CARRIED

### 4.3 Contract Award – Dreyer Drive Reconstruction

Committee Members asked questions regarding sidewalks along Dreyer Drive, impacts on Durham Regional Transit (DRT) routes, and timing of the project. R. Fernando and C. Bridgeman responded to questions from Committee Members and reviewed the phasing of the project and impacts to DRT routes.

Moved by: L. Bower

1. That the report on the contract award to Trisan Construction, in the amount of $3,859,593.54 (inclusive of all taxes) for the Dreyer Drive Reconstruction be received for information.

2. That the report on the contract award to R.V. Anderson in the amount of $221,310.50 (inclusive of all taxes) for the Dreyer Drive reconstruction Contract Administration and Material Testing services be received for information.

3. That the change in scope to the Road Resurfacing 2019 – FGT capital project eliminating the reconstruction of Admiral Road to the full reconstruction of Dreyer Drive be receive for information.

4. That Council approve funding of $177,205.07 to be allocated to capital Account No. 1002511 from Federal Gas Tax Reserve Fund.

CARRIED

### 4.4 Storm Sewer Repairs – T19029

Moved by: M. Crawford

1. That Council award the contract for Storm Sewer Repairs to BryRon Contracting Ltd. in the estimated amount of $64,410.00 (inclusive of all taxes), for a period of one year. This award includes planned work such as maintenance hole adjustments.

2. That Council authorize staff to have BryRon Contracting Ltd. perform any additional unplanned repair work that may arise based on fixed unit rates for such repairs. This unplanned work would encompass emergency repairs due to roadway failures that pose an immediate risk to public safety. Value of these types of repairs are estimated to be $229,039.71 annually.

3. That Council authorize staff to renew the contract for an additional four, one year periods, pending an analysis and satisfactory performance review at the anniversary date of the contract, in the estimated amount of $257,640.00 plus unplanned repairs of $916,158.83 (inclusive of all taxes).

CARRIED

### 4.5 Pre-Consultation By-law Update

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the proposed Pre-Consultation By-law (ATT-1) be forwarded to a future meeting of Council for approval.

CARRIED

### 4.6 Contract Award – Architectural Control Peer Review Services

Committee Members asked questions regarding the role and function of architectural control peer review, and whether such a service could be brought in-house. Geoff Romanowski, Acting Director of Planning & Development Services, and Shane Baker, Chief Administrative Officer, responded to questions from Committee Members and discussed considerations for contracting services for architectural control peer review.

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That Staff award the contract for Architectural Control Peer Review Services, to John G. Williams Ltd. Architect in the estimated amount of $172,042.50 (inclusive of all taxes), for a period of one year.

2. That Staff be authorized to renew the contract for an additional four, one year periods, pending an analysis and satisfactory performance review at the anniversary date of the contract, in the estimated amount of $741,524.68 (inclusive of all taxes).

CARRIED

### 4.7 Assumption of Subdivisions S-A-2007-03 Mulberry Meadows Phase 4 S-A-2005-01 Beechridge Phase 1

Moved by: M. Crawford

1. That the works and services within the following Plans of Subdivision be assumed by the Town:

   a) (S-A-2007-03) – Mulberry Meadows Phase 4
   Owner: Ajax Audley Development Limited
   Agreement Date: June 13, 2013

Registered Plan: 40M-2504
Refer to Appendix "A"

b) (S-A-2005-01) – Beechridge Phase 1 (Except Pond Block 156)
Owner: Beechridge Farms Inc. & Monarch Beechridge Ajax Inc.
Agreement Date: September 18, 2012
Registered Plan: 40M-2484
Refer to Appendix "B"

2. That the corresponding Assumption By-laws be prepared for an upcoming Council meeting.

CARRIED

### 4.8 Contract Award – Fishlock Stormwater Management Pond Rehabilitation

Committee Members asked questions regarding reasons for the over-budget amount, testing and management of the Town's stormwater ponds, and costs associated with maintaining the Town's stormwater pond inventory. Matthew Porporo, Infrastructure and Asset Management Technologist, responded to questions from Committee Members and discussed causes of the over-budget amount. S. Baker reviewed actions taken by other municipalities to manage financial costs associated with stormwater pond maintenance. S. Serrao reviewed grant funding received for stormwater pond management from the Clean Water and Wastewater Fund (CWWF).

Moved by: S. Lee

1. That the report on the contract award to CSL Group, in the amount of $108,944.03 (inclusive of all taxes) for the Fishlock Stormwater Management Pond Rehabilitation, be received for information.

2. That Council approve funding in the amount of $162,223.87 to be allocated to Capital Account No. 993111 from the Capital Contingency Reserve.

CARRIED

### 4.9 2020 Meeting Schedule and Committee Chair and Vice-Chair Appointments

Moved by: M. Crawford

That the 2020 Meeting Schedule and Committee Chair and Vice-Chair appointments be approved.

CARRIED

## 5. Discussion

### 5.1 Innovation Village

Lisa Hausz, Manager of Economic Development & Tourism discussed the contents of the written report and the recommendations contained therein, and invited questions and comments from Committee Members.

Committee Members asked questions regarding outreach to large technology companies, scope of the project, identified focus areas, project funding and grant opportunities, potential for revenue generation from the project, and selection of Pickering Village as the host location. L. Hausz responded to questions from Committee Members and reviewed the scope of the project and identified focus areas, overall project funding, potential sources of grants, and selection of the preferred location.

Moved by: L. Bower

1. That Council endorse Innovation Village, in principle;

2. That staff undertake the next steps in obtaining proposed design and construction costs and requirements for the Quaker House basement, Pickering Village Library and Mill St. Fire Hall to accommodate the Innovation Village;

3. That staff undertake an evaluation and facilitate the development of a public-private partnership to launch the operations and administration of the Innovation Village in Ajax, and report back to Council on details pertaining to possible structure, resources, community partnerships, and operating costs;

4. That Council authorize staff to make applications for applicable government grants, in partnership with the Region of Durham, Spark Centre, and other Durham municipalities in support of Innovation Village within the Durham Region Innovation District;

5. That Council support the application made by the Durham Economic Development Partnership through FedDev Ontario for the Durham Region Innovation District project, which the Innovation Village would be a part of;

6. That Council authorize staff to make an application through the Canadian Experience Fund (CEF) for the unmatched amount of $700,000.00 to facilitate infrastructure requirements for the proposed buildings, and if the application is successful, that Council direct staff to enter into a funding agreement, and advance equivalent project funding to commence the project and meet funding covenants;

7. That Council authorize staff to make applications for other applicable government grants, utilizing the support of Ajax's Member of Parliament and Provincial Member of Parliament, as required, that could fund the start-up and ongoing operations of the Innovation Village;

8. That staff attend the September 16th, 2019 Council Meeting to present a formal launch of the Innovation Village project; and

9. That staff report back to General Government Committee as needed, with updates, status reports and other information regarding the Innovation Village.

CARRIED

## 6. Presentations

### 6.2 New Highway 401 Crossing from Notion Road to Squires Beach Road – Municipal Class EA Update

John Grieve, Supervisor of Transportation, delivered a presentation reviewing the contents of the written report and the recommendations contained therein. J. Grieve discussed the background of the proposal, Municipal Class EA process, problem and opportunity statement, alternative solutions, alternative design concepts, environmental study report, preferred design concept, schedule and cost estimate, and next steps.

Committee Members asked questions regarding proximity and access to the St. Francis de Sales cemetery, cost differences between various alternatives, traffic volumes and impact on the surrounding area and Church Street, responsibility for costs to construct the preferred alternative, transportation infrastructure upgrades in the immediate vicinity, and timing of the phases of construction for Durham Live. J. Grieve responded to questions from Committee Members and discussed the timing of phases for the Durham Live project, transportation infrastructure upgrades on surrounding streets, traffic data collection on Church Street, and maintaining access to the cemetery.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin

That the report entitled "New Highway 401 Crossing from Notion Road to Squires Beach Road – Municipal Class EA Update" be received for information.

CARRIED

### 6.3 School Zone Management Plan

John Grieve, Supervisor of Transportation, delivered a presentation reviewing the contents of the written report and the recommendations contained therein. J. Grieve discussed the background of the plan, data collection process, warrant development, and next steps.

Committee Members asked questions regarding analysis of proposed locations for new crossing guards, use of bollards in school zones, training and standard practices for crossing guards, how pedestrian volume is calculated, and impact to traffic flows on Town roads. J. Grieve responded to questions from Committee Members and discussed use of bollards for traffic calming, application of the proposed warrant system to new crossing guard locations, data collection practices, and crossing guard training.

Moved by: S. Collier

1. That the report entitled "School Zone Management Plan" be received for information; and

2. That Council approve the warrant system for use in the deployment of crossing guards around Town.

CARRIED

## 6.4 Active and Safe Routes to School Program & School Travel Planning Program

Armi de Francia, Active Transportation Coordinator, delivered a presentation reviewing the contents of the written report and the recommendations contained therein. A. de Francia discussed common barriers to walking or cycling to school, active school travel in Ajax, the Active and Safe Routes to School Program, the School Travel Planning (STP) Program, funding available through the Ontario Active School Travel fund, STP schools, and progress to date.

Committee Members asked questions program success, costs and funding, incentives for participation, availability of bike racks at schools, and communication strategies. A. de Francia responded to questions from Committee Members and discussed program promotion through Ajax schools, incentives and prizes available to participating students, and promotional communications. J. Grieve discussed program costs, grant funding, and availability of bicycle racks and cycling infrastructure for students.

Moved by: S. Lee

That the report entitled "Active and Safe Routes to School Program & School Travel Planning Program" be received for information.

CARRIED

## 6.5 Festivals & Events Update

Robert Gruber, Manager, Community & Cultural Development and Poonam Swift, Corporate & Community Festivals & Events Coordinator, delivered a presentation regarding proposed updates to Town festivals and events. R. Gruber and P. Swift discussed current Town festivals and events, third party events, feedback and recommendations for Canada Day, Trailfest, and Doors Open, new ideas for festivals and events, and resource implications.

Committee Members asked questions regarding recommendations for Canada Day, Trailfest, and Doors Open, and consideration of more signature events within the Town. R. Gruber, P. Swift, and Tracey Vaughan, Director of Recreation, Culture and Community development, responded to questions from Committee Members and discussed consideration of different venues, costs and funding for current and new events, participation, and scheduling.

Moved by: S. Lee

That the Festivals & Events Update presentation be received for information.

CARRIED

## 6.6 Impact Ajax - Additional Streams

Robert Gruber, Manager, Community & Cultural Development and Cayla Da Silva, Community Development Coordinator, delivered a presentation regarding proposed changes to the IMPACT Ajax program. R. Gruber and C. Da Silva discussed the program's activities to date, community support program streams, and proposed new streams for sports, arts and culture, and festivals and events.

Committee Members asked questions regarding funding amounts for the new streams and eligibility criteria for different community groups and events in the Town. R. Gruber and T. Vaughan responded to questions from Committee Members and discussed available funding and eligibility for the proposed new streams.

Moved by: S. Collier

That the Impact Ajax – Additional Streams presentation be received for information.

CARRIED

**Closed Session (5:00 p.m.)**

**7. Authority to Hold a Closed Session**

Moved by: S. Lee

That the Committee convene to a Closed Session pursuant to Section 239 (2) (d) of the *Municipal Act, 2001,* as amended, to discuss a matter pertaining to labour relations or employee negotiations.

CARRIED

7.1 **A.P.F.F.A. Contract Negotiations**

**Open Meeting (5:11 p.m.)**

Moved by: S. Collier

That Council ratify the Ajax Professional Fire Fighters Association (A.P.F.F.A.) contract changes and renew the collective agreement, effective January 1, 2019 to December 31, 2021.

CARRIED

**8. Adjournment (5:12 p.m.)**

Moved by: L. Bower

That the September 9, 2019 meeting of the General Government Committee be adjourned.

CARRIED

Chair

D-Clerk